OUR LADY OF FATIMA UNIVERSITY

Workplace Documents:
Business Letter & Email

Purposive Communication (PURC111)

Week 14

Agenda

- Workplace Documents
- Business Letter/Emails

Workplace Documents

- It can be **informational or persuasive.**
- **provide a record of correspondence**, which are important in situations where legal concerns may arise.
- **ensures efficient delivery of information** within an organization

Workplace Documents

- In writing workplace documents, the goal is always to make it **clear, concise**, and **professional.**
- Examples may include but are not limited to:
  - email
  - memorandum
  - letters
  - reports
  - cover sheets
  - minutes of the meeting

Writing a Business Letter

Business letters are **formal communications** within a professional setting and serve as **legal documents between parties**, so it is important that all information is **accurate and legitimate**.

Writing a Business Letter

A business letter is...

- is a legal document
- used to request and provide information
- must be concise and clear
- preferably written in first-person.

Styles of Business Letters

Full block style

- The entire text is **left aligned and single spaced.**

Nathan
1234 Fake address
Salt Lake City, UT 84000
801-123-4567

Dear Example,

This is an example letter to help give an example of a block letter. This is an example letter to help give an example of a block letter. This is an example letter to help give an example of a block letter. This is an example letter to help give an example of a block letter. This is an example letter to help give an example of a block letter. This is an example letter to help give an example of a block letter. This is an example letter to help give an example of a block letter. This is an example letter to help give an example of a block letter. This is an example letter to help give an example of a block letter.

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Sincerely,

Nathan

Styles of Business Letters

Modified block style

- The return address, date, complimentary closing, and the signature line are **slightly to the right of the center of the paper.**

Gregory Donaldson
Minoan Inc
247 Madison Ave.,Suite 2103
New York, NY 10015

December 3, 2006

Dixie Cleverelle
Savbizcor Ltd
28 Green St., Suite 14
Upstate, NY 10947

Dear Ms. Cleverelle:

The first shipment of equipment from Savbizcor Ltd has arrived. We are delighted with every piece. Therefore, we decided to make our initial purchase larger than anticipated. I am attaching our purchase order No. 8930 for additional goods totaling list price $700,000.

Since you already have a copy of our Procurement Guidelines, I shall not attach them to this order. As before, we will establish a letter of credit. Please inform me of shipping dates.

Sincerely,

G. Donaldson

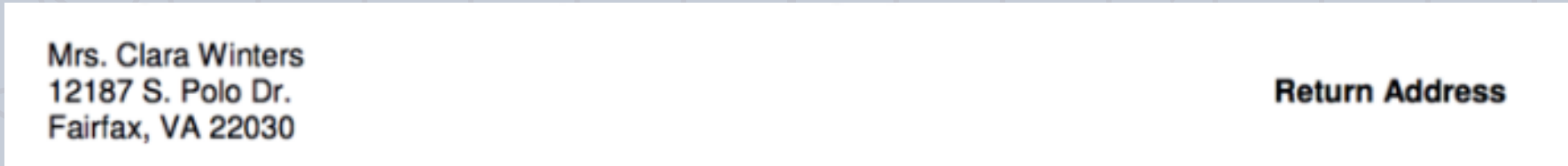
Gregory Donaldson,
Chief Procurement Officer

Enclosure: Purchase Order No. 8930

Elements of a Standard Business Letter

Return Address

Your address or the address of the company you represent.



Elements of a Standard Business Letter

Date

Leave **two blank lines after the return address**. Always **spell out the month** and include the day, a comma, and the year.

Mrs. Clara Winters
12187 S. Polo Dr.
Fairfax, VA 22030

Return Address

May 26, 2002

Date

Elements of a Standard Business Letter

Inside Address

Leave **two blank lines after the date**. Then type the address of the person or company to whom you are writing.

May 26, 2002 **Date**

The Tiny Tots Toy Company
15456 Pyramid Way Inside
College Park, FL 33133 **Address**

Elements of a Standard Business Letter

Salutation

Type **Dear,** followed by the person's name. End the line with a colon. If you don't know the name of the person, **use a title instead**. (i.e. Dear Madam)

The Tiny Tots Toy Company
15456 Pyramid Way Inside
College Park, FL 33133

Address

Dear Customer Service Representative:

Salutation

Elements of a Standard Business Letter

Body

Align your message **on the left margin**. Skip a line before starting a new paragraph, but **do not indent** the paragraph's first line. Make sure that each paragraph is clear and concise.

I recently purchased one of your Tiny Tents (Model #47485) for my three-year old. **Body**
Unfortunately, after viewing the components that came with the product, I discovered that four of the parts were missing. Also, the instructions that came with the tent are in Portuguese and Russian, but not in English or French, the two languages I speak. These two unforeseen problems have resulted in the tent remaining unassembled and unacceptable as a toy for my daughter.

I am writing to request replacements for the missing parts, and a copy of the full set of assembly instructions (in English or French) for the model I purchased. If reasonable arrangements are not made within ten business days, I will return the tent to the store I purchased it from and expect a full refund. To assist you in processing my request, I am including a copy of my sales receipt and a list of the missing parts.

Elements of a Standard Business Letter

Closing

Leave two lines of space after your last body paragraph, then use a conventional closing, followed by a comma (i.e., Sincerely, Sincerely Yours, Respectfully).

I have purchased other toys manufactured by your company in the past, and have always been impressed with the quality and selection that Tiny Tots has made available to its customers. I sincerely hope this is a one-time incident, and that any future purchases I make will live up to the standard my family has come to expect from your company.

Sincerely, **Closing**

Elements of a Standard Business Letter

Signature

Your signature should appear below your closing. Unless you have established a personal relationship with the person you are writing, **use both your first and last name**.

Signature

Clara Winters **Typed Name**

Enc: 2 **Abbreviation**

Elements of a Standard Business Letter

Signature

Four lines after the closing, type your full name. **Do not include a title** (Mr. or Mrs.). If you are writing on behalf of an organization, type your title **on the next line**.

Signature

Clara Winters **Typed Name**

Enc: 2 **Abbreviation**

Elements of a Standard Business Letter

Abbreviations at the end of a letter

- **cc** (carbon copy): used when sending a copy of a letter to someone other than the person addressed

  cc: Juan Dela Cruz

- **Enc** (Enclosure): used when you attach/enclose documents with the letter. Indicate the number of documents enclosed.

Enc: 2 **Abbreviation**

Elements of a Standard Business Letter

Abbreviations at the end of a letter

- **writer's initials:** if someone else typed the letter, put the writer's initials in capitals, then a slash and the typist's initials in lowercase. Just one abbreviation should appear on a line.

writer's name: Taylor Swift

typist's name: Stefani Germanotta

TS/sg

Enc: 2

Abbreviation

Formatting your Business Letter

- Use single spacing. **NEVER** use double spaces.
- Use a simple font style that is easy to read.
- Leave a blank line between each paragraph. This makes it easier to follow the changes of topic within the letter.

Formatting your Business Letter

Introduction:

- This paragraph should **introduce why you are writing the letter** and **sum up the key points** in the following paragraphs.
- Include a statement that **shows you are knowledgeable of the audience** to which your letter is directed.

Formatting your Business Letter

The Body:

- Provide background or history regarding the purpose of the letter.
- Talk about **key points** you are making.
- Include **a justification of the importance** of the main points.
- **List any important dates, discussions, and conversations** that are relevant.
- Ask questions, if necessary.

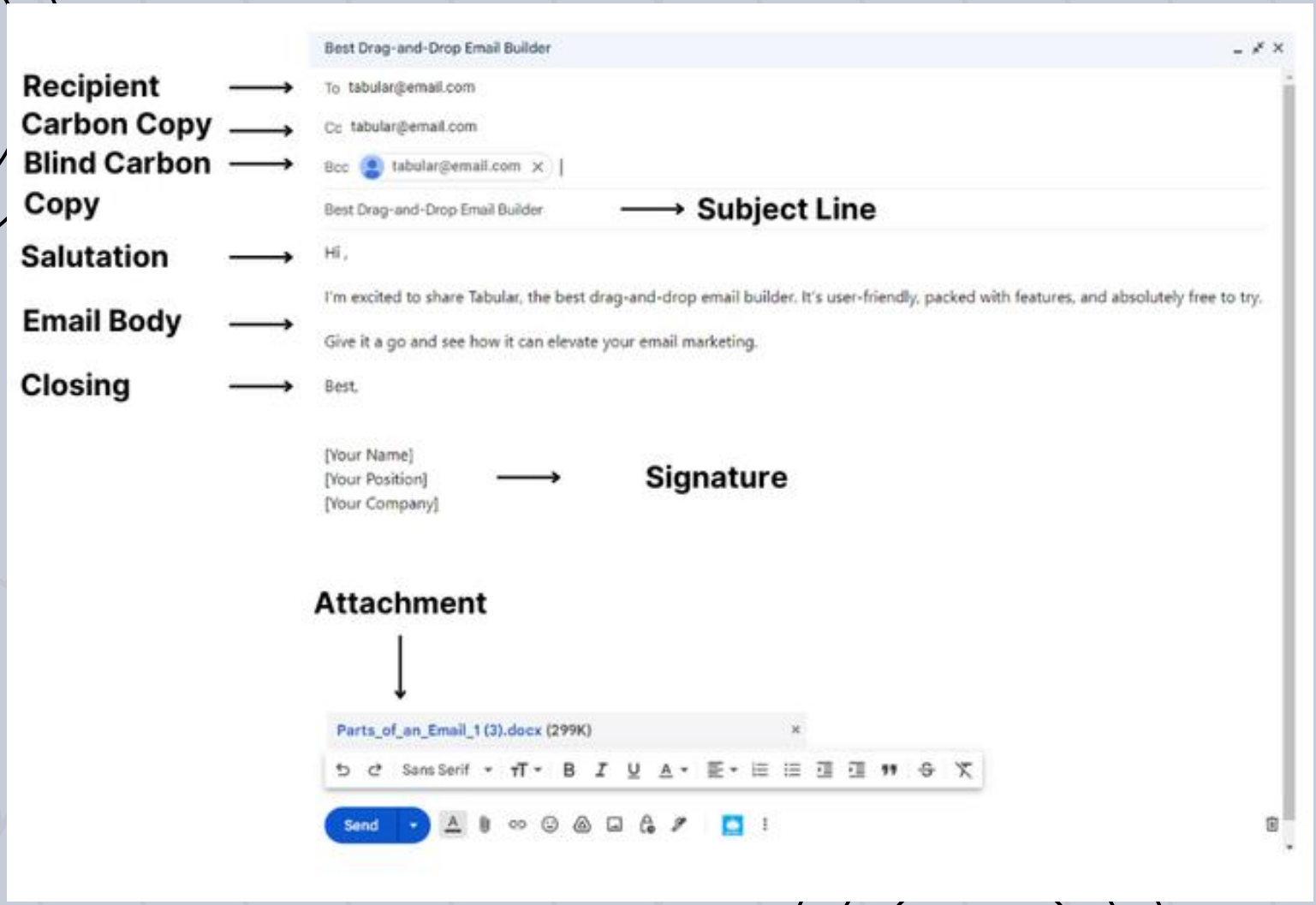
Formatting your Business Letter

Conclusion:

- **Summarize** the main points of the letter.
- Restate the problem and resolution if pertinent.
- Include deadlines.
- Provide contact information (Email, Phone Number, Fax, Etc.).

Business Emails

Emails are written communications primarily used in sending information.


Best Drag-and-Drop Email Builder
Recipient
To tabular@email.com
Carbon Copy
Cc tabular@email.com
Blind Carbon Copy
Bcc tabular@email.com
Best Drag-and-Drop Email Builder
Subject Line
Salutation
Hi ,
Email Body
I'm excited to share Tabular, the best drag-and-drop email builder. It's user-friendly, packed with features, and absolutely free to try.
Give it a go and see how it can elevate your email marketing.
Closing
Best,
[Your Name]
[Your Position]
[Your Company]
Signature
Attachment
Parts_of_an_Email_1 (3).docx (299K)
Sans Serif
Send

Addressing an email

When you send an email, you have three field choices: **“to”, “cc”, and “bcc”.**

- **To:** Add the email addresses of the main recipients.
- **Cc:** Add the email addresses of those who should see the email (visible to everyone).
- **Bcc:** Add the email addresses of those who should see the email but stay hidden from others.

Addressing an email

Why would you “cc” someone?

- Keeps someone informed without involving them directly.
- Useful for updates, meeting summaries, or reminders for action.
- Shows recipients who else is copied on the email.
- Often used in business to emphasize the importance of the email to the primary recipient.

Addressing an email

Why would you “bcc” someone?

- Keeps recipients' email addresses private.
- Commonly used for large mailing lists to protect privacy.
- Allows someone to stay informed without others knowing they received the email.
- In business, can discreetly involve superiors or others in a conversation.
- Prevents “BCC” recipients from getting "reply all" emails.

Key points in writing a business email

- **Be concise.** Try to keep to a maximum length of five paragraphs. If your message is very long consider sending it as an attachment.
- Don’t use an inappropriate email address from which to send your email (***naruto1996@gmail.com***). **If you do not have a business email address,** set one up using your name or your company name.

Key points in writing a business email

- Make sure you **title your email clearly in the subject box.** Try to keep titles short.
- Use bulleted lists and keep paragraphs short.
- **Do not use block capitals**. They give the impression you are shouting at your reader.
- **Do not use emojis/emoticons** in formal emails.
- Avoid slangs or abbreviations.

Key points in writing a business email

- Don't be sloppy with grammar or ignore formatting. It may be quicker to write your email without using capital letters, but **it looks unprofessional to the reader.**
- **Always reply to an email as soon as possible** to show the sender that you are dealing with the information.

Prepared by:
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